

JOHN LASALANDRA and Joe Hicks will be going heads up in the E-stock International Hot Rod Assn. duel, and it might get down to a repeat of the nationals, where they met before.

Winning this match was Hicks, as far as the class went (F-S, F-3), but LaSalandra put his car, "Shaft" in the record books by establishing a new world record for the class with an 11:86 E.T. and 114.69 miles per hour.

Both cars are nearly identical, varying only in makeup and camshaft. Hicks owns and drives his car, while LaSalandra is the driver of his and shares the ownership with Chuck McCollum.

WHAT MAKES it such a

Split With Tech—

Miners Get 'Em Home In 2nd Tilt, Win

Andy Cohen's U.T. El Paso Miner baseball team left too many men on base in the first game of a twin-bill with Texas Tech, but was able to move them around in the nightcap.

UTEP left 11 men stranded in the first game at Dudley Field; and dropped the opener 5-1, but used key hits and a fine pitching job to win the second 3-2.

IN THE OPENER the Miners couldn't get anything going off the arm of Tech hurler Ruben Garcia, who leveled off with a good fast ball and curve.

A two-run homer by Tech outfielder Cecil Norris got things going for the Raiders in the opener. They added two more on Doug Ault's two-run blast in the fourth and added the last run in the sixth inning.

In that game Garcia fanned 10 Miners and only allowed them six hits.

THE NIGHTCAP looked like it might be a repeat of the opener, as Tech jumped off to an early 1-0 lead, but UTEP brought it back to a tie with Frank Del Torro's blast in the fourth. Barry Alburdis put it away for the Miners in the sixth with a two-run shot.

Del Torro also went the distance on the mound for Miners picking up his first win of the season.

Cohen said, "I'm quite pleased with the team at this point in the season. If they keep improving, they'll be a good team by the time the end of the season rolls around."

UTEP is now 3-1.

TEXAS TECH	202	001	0-5	8	9
UTEP	000	000	1-1	6	4

Garcia and Hazzard, Peden and Newsome. Garcia W (2-0); W; Peden L (1-1).

They Get Another Chance This Year—

Once Upon a Time, El Paso Baseball Fans Turned Out

By PETE CICCARELLI

THE TARNISHED TROPHY sat on its once burnished mahogany base. One had to fight the long nets of cobwebs to brush away the dust and in the gloomy light of Dudley Field's ticket office read the inscription: EL PASO SUN KINGS — GRAND SWEEPSTAKES WINNER — NATIONAL ATTENDANCE DERBY — 1961.

Too many, it is hard to believe that El Paso baseball fans once turned out in such a number that they were honored throughout the country. But baseball fever once reigned supreme in the Sun City only to meet an unfriendly and brutal ambush in 1970.

The years when the "Sun Kings" were farmhands of the front running San Francisco Giants are gone now, remaining as only an affectionate memory in reminiscences of many a local fan.

AFTER THE GIANTS pulled up stakes in 1965, the El Paso Sports Assn. looked for another affiliation. The 40 man team of sports oriented businessmen found a willing partner in the California Angels. Once again people flocked to the tattered confines of Dudley Field to lend to the enthusiasm of a new ball club. But soon, however, the cost of operating a minor league baseball club grew to immense proportions. The 40 underwriters bowed out on top in 1969, clinging to fond memories and a hope that baseball's success would continue.

That hope soon became a nightmare. The new owner was a midwest businessman, Ray A. Johnston. Johnston had no desire to remain in El Paso and oversee the baseball operation in 1970 so he hired Bob Morris, as general manager.

THE SUN KINGS were left in the desert with very little water to drink. There was no money in the till for advertising.

The 1970 Sun Kings contended for the Texas League Western Division title until the last series of the season. Attendance was humiliating. As one player put it, "It's hard playing every night with no one watching you, but I really can't blame them, if I weren't playing, I darn sure wouldn't come out here."

It wasn't the sports fan that stripped El Paso of professional baseball, rather it was the game itself. Baseball stopped promoting itself and in doing so made enemies out of long time supporters.

DUDLEY FIELD was 36 years old and had never been painted. The prices were high and the seats were uncomfortable. The concessions area was dirty, the food poor and the prices ridiculous.

At season's end Ray Johnston announced the withdrawal of his club from El Paso claiming that there was no local support. He was three months late, the long time El Paso baseball fans had surrendered in June.

* NEXT: Part II: "A new Mayor; baseball returns."

Joe Graig Bay Scores GG Knockout

FORT WORTH (UPI) — Flyweight Joe Graig Bay of El Paso scored a knockout victory over Naylon Lowery of Temple in the second of the 36th annual State Golden Gloves Boxing Tournament.

IN OTHER ACTION, light middleweight, Victor Hurtado ached his second ring victory in two nights by getting a decision over Stanley Jones of Odessa. Lightweight Ben Miralles of El Paso decided

middleweight Earl McFadden of Wichita Falls decided Ray Luzero of El Paso; Pat Ozuna of El Paso Armando Reyes of El Paso and Armando Hernandez of El Paso defeated Jim Leveritt of Odessa with a TKO in the third round.

Dallas kept its lead in the team scoring with seven points overall.

Miner Freshmen